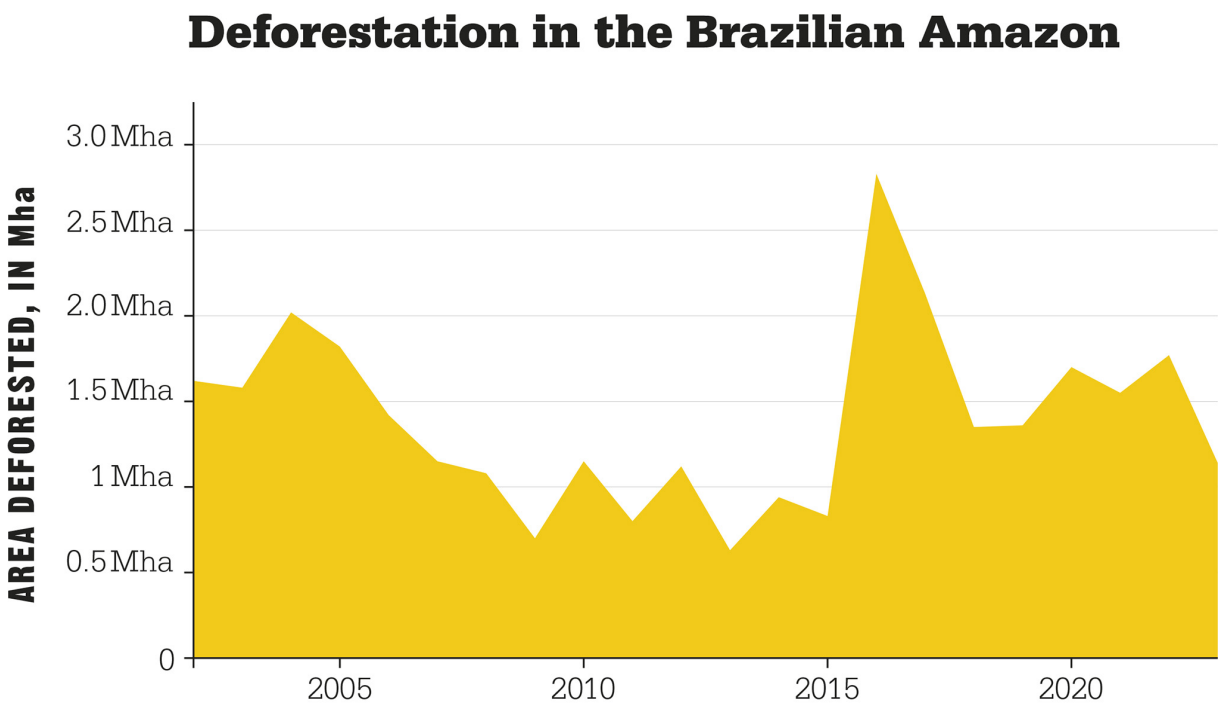


The depleting rainforest cover in the Amazon Basin is a global concern. While there are many reasons behind the deforestation in Brazil, the largest single cause is the expansion of pasture land for beef production.

Read accessible description

Reforesting Earth

Currently, about 31 percent of Earth's habitable land surface is covered by forests, but that figure is rapidly decreasing in some parts of the world. However, there are regions, including Europe, where forest areas are gradually expanding. Measures to restrict deforestation include payments to communities for conserving forest, and the creation of extractive reserves, where local people can harvest products sustainably.

Globally, alternative sources of fuel need to be found, along with new ways to develop less land-hungry forms of agriculture. A few nations are taking the lead in reforestation programs. For example, a project in which people from 500 villages have planted 150 million mangrove trees on the